

SKELETONS: SPECIES VARIANTS



SKELETONS: SPECIES VARIANTS IS A MONSTER SUPPLEMENT FOR 5E THAT PRESENTS SKELETONS AS STRUCTURAL UNDEAD rather than disposable minions. Instead of treating skeletons as a single interchangeable stat block, this book expands the concept across multiple peoples and monstrous bodies—each preserving exactly one biomechanical racial trait while remaining mindless, cultureless animated bone.

The intent of this product is mechanical clarity and tactical pressure without numerical escalation.

Humanoid variants operate at low CR and are designed to function in groups, forcing weapon adaptation through their Structural Undead doctrine: immunity to piercing damage, resistance to slashing damage, vulnerability to bludgeoning damage, and immunity to poison and necrotic damage. Larger skeletal bodies scale naturally according to their physical frame, not through spellcasting or retained intelligence.

Each skeleton fills a battlefield niche defined purely by anatomy—dense dwarven anchors, swift elven frames, compact halfling interiors, long-limbed bugbear reach controllers, aquatic merfolk hunters, charging minotaur shock units, and colossal giant war engines. These creatures do not command. They do not strategize. They simply move, strike, and rattle forward as animated structure.

Cultural memory, motive, and personality are intentionally absent. Whether raised by battlefield necromancy, ancient curses, lingering magic in forgotten tombs, or divine punishment is left to the GM. Use these stat blocks as tools. Why the bones rise is yours to decide.

SKELETONS ROSTER

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Human Skeleton	1/4	Baseline animated bones; structural undead armed with common martial weapons.
Dwarf Skeleton	1/4	Dense skeletal anchor that resists forced movement and bears shield and hammer.
Elf Skeleton	1/4	Light, swift skeletal frame that pressures with superior mobility.
Halfling Skeleton	1/4	Compact skeletal threat effective in tight interiors and confined spaces.
Gnome Skeleton	1/4	Arcane-resistant bone lattice suited to magical ruins and workshops.
Ratfolk Skeleton	1/4	Narrow-framed sewer climber adapted to vertical stone and damp tunnels.
Goblin Skeleton	1/4	Nimble skirmishing bones that reposition quickly between strikes.
Hobgoblin Skeleton	1/4	Formation-oriented skeletal frame that stiffens allied positioning.
Orc Skeleton	1/4	Heavy-boned shock attacker that strikes with aggressive momentum.
Gnoll Skeleton	1/4	Predatory skeletal pursuer that pressures the wounded and prone.
Bugbear Skeleton	1/4	Long-limbed skeletal controller that threatens extended reach.
Merfolk Skeleton	1/4	Aquatic skeletal hunter with powerful swim speed and trident reach.
Lizardfolk Skeleton	1/4	Reinforced bone structure with shield-bearing swamp durability.
Dragonborn Skeleton	1/4	Draconic skeletal frame with residual breath cavity and martial presence.
Ogre Skeleton	2	Large skeletal brute wielding crushing force and heavy structural mass.
Minotaur Skeleton	3	Charging skeletal war beast that shatters lines through momentum.
Troll Skeleton	4	Unstable reassembling skeletal horror that must be crushed to stay down.
Hill Giant Skeleton	6	Colossal skeletal engine of destruction that collapses violently when shattered.

HALFLING SKELETON

Small undead, unaligned

Armor Class 14 (natural armor)

Hit Points 9 (3d6)

Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)	8 (-1)	5 (-3)

Damage Immunities poison, necrotic, piercing

Damage Resistances slashing

Damage Vulnerabilities bludgeoning

Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9

Languages —

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Undead Nature. Undead do not require air, food, drink, or sleep.

Structural Undead. This skeleton represents compact animated bone reinforced by necromantic force rather than living tissue.

Small Frame. Attack rolls against this skeleton have disadvantage if the attacker is Large or larger.

Jaw Rattle. The hollow, rhythmic clicking of animated bone—teeth chattering in empty skulls, joints grinding in unnatural cadence—creates a deeply unnerving sound. When a creature starts its turn within 10 ft. of this skeleton and can hear it, that creature must succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the start of its next turn.

ACTIONS:

Shortsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

Shortbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

- This skeleton uses mobility and size to harry larger foes.
- It weaves through tighter spaces and fights from partial cover when possible.
- It favors ranged attacks before closing for melee.
- In groups, it focuses fire on isolated targets.



LIZARDFOLK SKELETON

Medium undead, unaligned

Armor Class 15 (natural armor, shield)

Hit Points 15 (3d8 + 3)

Speed 30 ft., swim 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	6 (-2)	8 (-1)	5 (-3)

Damage Immunities poison, necrotic, piercing

Damage Resistances slashing

Damage Vulnerabilities bludgeoning

Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9

Languages —

Challenge 1/4 (50 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Undead Nature. Undead do not require air, food, drink, or sleep.

Structural Undead. This skeleton represents thick, reinforced animated bone preserved for durability rather than life.

Reinforced Frame. This skeleton's natural armor reflects dense bone structure.

Jaw Rattle. The hollow, rhythmic clicking of animated bone—teeth chattering in empty skulls, joints grinding in unnatural cadence—creates a deeply unnerving sound. When a creature starts its turn within 10 ft. of this skeleton and can hear it, that creature must succeed on a DC 10 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the start of its next turn.

ACTIONS:

Spear. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 1) piercing damage.

- This skeleton advances steadily through swamp water or flooded terrain.
- It uses shield and spear to hold ground in shallow water.
- It focuses attacks on creatures attempting to escape the marsh.
- It fights without fear and does not retreat.



MINOTAUR SKELETON

Large undead, unaligned

Armor Class 11 (natural armor)

Hit Points 45 (6d10 + 12)

Speed 40 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)	6 (-2)	8 (-1)	7 (-2)

Damage Immunities poison, necrotic, piercing

Damage Resistances slashing

Damage Vulnerabilities bludgeoning

Condition Immunities exhaustion, poisoned

Senses darkvision 60 ft., passive Perception 9

Languages —

Challenge 3 (700 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Undead Nature. Undead do not require air, food, drink, or sleep.

Structural Undead. This skeleton represents a massive animated bone frame reinforced by necromantic force rather than living tissue.

Goring Charge. If this skeleton moves at least 20 ft. straight toward a target and then hits it with a Gore attack on the same turn, the target takes an extra 9 (2d8) piercing damage.

Jaw Rattle. The hollow, rhythmic clicking of animated bone—teeth chattering in empty skulls, joints grinding in unnatural cadence—creates a deeply unnerving sound. When a creature starts its turn within 10 ft. of this skeleton and can hear it, that creature must succeed on a DC 12 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on the next attack roll it makes before the start of its next turn.

ACTIONS:

Greataxe. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 17 (2d12 + 4) slashing damage.

Gore. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 13 (2d8 + 4) piercing damage.

- This skeleton opens combat with its breath weapon if available.
- It then advances directly into melee range.
- It focuses attacks on the largest visible threat.
- It fights without fear and does not retreat.



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